



EAST TEXAS A&M
— UNIVERSITY —

CSCI 352.61E

DIGITAL FORENSICS

CARVING/RECOVERING A USB IMAGE

using scalpel

PREPARE A USB IMAGE FOR FILE CARVING

Download the zipped USB image

```
(root👤kali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# wget -q https://raw.githubusercontent.com/frankwxu/digital-forensics-lab/main/Basic_Computer_Skills_for_Forensics/file_carving/usb_image/120M.7z

(root👤kali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# ls -l 120M.7z
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 36720470 Sep 24 09:03 120M.7z
```

Compute hashes

```
(root👤kali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# hashdeep -c md5,sha1 120M.7z
%%% HASHDEEP-1.0
%%% size,md5,sha1,filename
## Invoked from: /root/carvingLab
## # hashdeep -c md5,sha1 120M.7z
##
36720470,dfе7b5424e54cd1bf50d5df47aceeb3c,2810745018afaa2da31dc17a8eb590fca66eeef7,/root/carvingLab/120M.7z
```

Annotations in the terminal output:

- md5 points to the MD5 hash: `dfе7b5424e54cd1bf50d5df47aceeb3c`
- sha1 points to the SHA1 hash: `2810745018afaa2da31dc17a8eb590fca66eeef7`
- size points to the file size: `36720470`

List the content of the zipped file

```
(root@kali80)-[~/carvingLab]  
# 7z l 120M.7z
```

```
7-Zip [64] 16.02 : Copyright (c) 1999-2016 Igor Pavlov : 2016-05-21  
p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,2 CPUs Intel(R) Xe  
on(R) Gold 6226R CPU @ 2.90GHz (50650),ASM,AES-NI)
```

```
Scanning the drive for archives:  
1 file, 36720470 bytes (36 MiB)
```

```
Listing archive: 120M.7z
```

```
--
```

```
Path = 120M.7z
```

```
Type = 7z
```

```
Physical Size = 36720470
```

```
Headers Size = 214
```

```
Method = LZMA2:24
```

```
Solid = +
```

```
Blocks = 1
```

content of the zip

Date	Time	Attr	Size	Compressed	Name
2021-09-22	22:59:31	D...A	0	0	120M
2021-09-22	22:59:31	A	124780544	36720256	120M/usb_fat_carving.001
2021-09-22	22:59:32	A	1685		120M/usb_fat_carving.001.txt
2021-09-22	22:59:32		124782229	36720256	2 files, 1 folders

List the content of the zipped file

```
(root@kali80)-[~/carvingLab]  
# 7z e 120M.7z
```

```
7-Zip [64] 16.02 : Copyright (c) 1999-2016 Igor Pavlov : 2016-05-21  
p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,2 CPUs Intel(R) Xe  
on(R) Gold 6226R CPU @ 2.90GHz (50650),ASM,AES-NI)
```

```
Scanning the drive for archives:  
1 file, 36720470 bytes (36 MiB)
```

```
Extracting archive: 120M.7z
```

```
--
```

```
Path = 120M.7z  
Type = 7z  
Physical Size = 36720470  
Headers Size = 214  
Method = LZMA2:24  
Solid = +  
Blocks = 1
```

e : Extract files from archive (without using directory names)

```
Everything is Ok
```

```
Folders: 1  
Files: 2  
Size:      124782229  
Compressed: 36720470
```


Verify the hashes

```
(rootkali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# hashdeep -c md5,sha1 usb fat carving.001
%%% HASHDEEP-1.0
%%% size,md5,sha1,filename
## Invoked from: /root/carvingLab
## # hashdeep -c md5,sha1 usb_fat_carving.001
##
124780544,ba4a1d0ba49f4a6667b00a3b3e85e604,bcc2d49fd49c9521ecb1739f6542c6bf327375ef,/root/carvingLab/usb_fat_carving.001

(rootkali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# cat usb fat carving.001.txt | grep "checksum"
MD5 checksum: ba4a1d0ba49f4a6667b00a3b3e85e604
SHA1 checksum: bcc2d49fd49c9521ecb1739f6542c6bf327375ef
MD5 checksum: ba4a1d0ba49f4a6667b00a3b3e85e604 : verified
SHA1 checksum: bcc2d49fd49c9521ecb1739f6542c6bf327375ef : verified
```

EXAM THE CONTENT OF THE USB

Display partitions

```
(root@kali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# fdisk -l usb_fat_carving.001
```

Disk usb_fat_carving.001: 119 MiB, 124780544 bytes, 243712 sectors
Units: sectors of 1 * 512 = 512 bytes
Sector size (logical/physical): 512 bytes / 512 bytes
I/O size (minimum/optimal): 512 bytes / 512 bytes
Disklabel type: dos
Disk identifier: 0xa1159a00

Device	Boot	Start	End	Sectors	Size	Id	Type
usb_fat_carving.001p1	*	128	243711	243584	118.9M	e	W95 FAT16 (LBA)

Find deleted files

```
(root@kali80) - [~/carvingLab]
# fls -o 128 usb_fat_carving.001
r/r 3: USB (Volume Label Entry)
d/d 6: System Volume Information
r/r * 7: _est
r/r 10: .dropbox.device
d/d * 13: old_File_Carving_files
r/r * 15: B_ub_poe4.bmp
r/r * 18: B_zoom-eubie-mono.bmp
r/r * 21: Ballardlab8.java
r/r * 24: brittLab10.java
r/r * 27: DO_example.doc
r/r * 30: DO_example2.doc deleted
r/r * 33: G_BuiltForThis.gif
r/r * 35: G_zoom-sc.gif
r/r * 37: H_Form.html
r/r * 39: H_hello.html
r/r * 41: J_ub_law.jpg
r/r * 44: J_ub_night.jpg
r/r * 47: nps-2008-jean_outlook.pst
r/r * 50: P_CAS-zoom-6.png
r/r * 53: P_MSB_1_zoom.png
r/r * 57: pd_Evidence_search_techniques.pdf
r/r * 61: pd_Forensic_Report_Template.pdf
r/r * 64: pp_Number_Systems.pptx
r/r * 67: pp_one_page.pptx
r/r 69: readme.docx
r/r 70: readme.txt deleted
r/r * 71: _tf_1.rtf
r/r * 74: T_eubie-iphone-5-8.tiff
r/r * 78: T_youknowus-iphone-5-8.tiff
r/r * 81: W_axloadcomplete.wav
r/r * 84: W_speaker_test_sound.wav
r/r * 86: Z_file.zip
r/r * 88: 江莎莎行踪轨迹.doc
r/r * 91: nps-2008-jean_outlook.pst
v/v 3889667: $MBR
v/v 3889668: $FAT1
v/v 3889669: $FAT2
V/V 3889670: $OrphanFiles
```


DECIDE WHICH FILE TYPES NEED TO CARVE

```
(root@kali80) - [~/carvingLab]
# leafpad /etc/scalpel/scalpel.conf
/usr/share/themes/Kali-Dark/gtk-2.0/gtkrc:39: Unable to find include file: "apps.rc"
/usr/share/themes/Kali-Dark/gtk-2.0/gtkrc:40: Unable to find include file: "hacks.rc"
/usr/share/themes/Kali-Dark/gtk-2.0/gtkrc:41: Unable to find include file: "hacks-dark.r
```

C''

1

```

#-----
#
# Here is an example of how to use the no extension option. Any files
# beginning with the string "FOREMOST" are carved and no file extensions
# are used. No footer is defined and the max carve size is 1000 bytes.
#
#     NONE      y      1000      FOREMOST
#
#-----
# GRAPHICS FILES
#-----
#
# AOL ART files
#     art      y      150000    \x4a\x47\x04\x0e      \xcf\xcb\xcb
#     art      y      150000    \x4a\x47\x03\x0e      \xd0\xcb\x00\x00
#
# GIF and JPG files (very common)
#     gif      y      5000000    \x47\x49\x46\x38\x37\x61      \x00\x3b
#     gif      y      5000000    \x47\x49\x46\x38\x39\x61      \x00\x3b
#     jpg      y      5242880    \xff\xd8\xff???Exif      \xff\xd9      REVERSE
#     jpg      y      5242880    \xff\xd8\xff???JFIF      \xff\xd9      REVERSE

```

Save it and quit!

uncomment #

Show help

```
(root@kali80)~[~/carvingLab]
# scalpel -h
Scalpel version 1.60
Written by Golden G. Richard III, based on Foremost 0.69.
Carves files from a disk image based on file headers and footers.

Usage: scalpel [-b] [-c <config file>] [-d] [-h|V] [-i <file>]
              [-m blocksize] [-n] [-o <outputdir>] [-O num] [-q clustersize]
              [-r] [-s num] [-t <blockmap file>] [-u] [-v]
              <imgfile> [<imgfile>] ...

-b Carve files even if defined footers aren't discovered within
  maximum carve size for file type [foremost 0.69 compat mode].
-c Choose configuration file.
-d Generate header/footer database; will bypass certain optimizations
  and discover all footers, so performance suffers. Doesn't affect
  the set of files carved. **EXPERIMENTAL**
-h Print this help message and exit.
-i Read names of disk images from specified file.
-m Generate/update carve coverage blockmap file. The first 32bit
  unsigned int in the file identifies the block size. Thereafter
  each 32bit unsigned int entry in the blockmap file corresponds
  to one block in the image file. Each entry counts how many
  carved files contain this block. Requires more memory and
  disk. **EXPERIMENTAL**
-n Don't add extensions to extracted files.
-o Set output directory for carved files.
-O Don't organize carved files by type. Default is to organize carved files
  into subdirectories.
-p Perform image file preview; audit log indicates which files
  would have been carved, but no files are actually carved.
-q Carve only when header is cluster-aligned.
-r Find only first of overlapping headers/footers [foremost 0.69 compat mode].
-s Skip n bytes in each disk image before carving.
-t Set directory for coverage blockmap. **EXPERIMENTAL**
-u Use carve coverage blockmap when carving. Carve only sections
  of the image whose entries in the blockmap are 0. These areas
  are treated as contiguous regions. **EXPERIMENTAL**
```


CARVING THE USB IMAGE

```
(root👁kali80)-[~/carvingLab]
# scalpel usb fat carving.001 -o output 1 ✖
Scalpel version 1.60
Written by Golden G. Richard III, based on Foremost 0.69.

Opening target "/root/carvingLab/usb_fat_carving.001"

Image file pass 1/2.
usb_fat_carving.001: 100.0% |*****| 119.0 MB 00:00 ETA
Allocating work queues...
Work queues allocation complete. Building carve lists...
Carve lists built. Workload:
jpg with header "\xff\xd8\xff\x3f\x3f\x3f\x45\x78\x69\x66" and footer "\xff\xd9" --> 8 f
iles
jpg with header "\xff\xd8\xff\x3f\x3f\x3f\x4a\x46\x49\x46" and footer "\xff\xd9" --> 9 f
iles
Carving files from image.
Image file pass 2/2.
usb_fat_carving.001: 100.0% |*****| 119.0 MB 00:00 ETA
Processing of image file complete. Cleaning up...
Done.
Scalpel is done, files carved = 17, elapsed = 0 seconds.
```

Show carved
files

```
(rootkali80)-[~/carvingLab]  
# tree output
```

```
output
```

```
├── audit.txt
```

```
├── jpg-0-0
```

```
│   ├── 00000000.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000001.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000002.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000003.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000004.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000005.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000006.jpg
```

```
│   └── 00000007.jpg
```

```
├── jpg-1-0
```

```
│   ├── 00000008.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000009.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000010.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000011.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000012.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000013.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000014.jpg
```

```
│   ├── 00000015.jpg
```

```
│   └── 00000016.jpg
```

carved files

```
2 directories, 18 files
```


Show audit log

```
(root@kali80)-[~/carvingLab]  
# cat output/audit.txt
```

```
Scalpel version 1.60 audit file  
Started at Fri Sep 24 11:20:43 2021  
Command line:  
scalpel usb_fat_carving.001 -o output
```

```
Output directory: /root/carvingLab/output  
Configuration file: /etc/scalpel/scalpel.conf
```

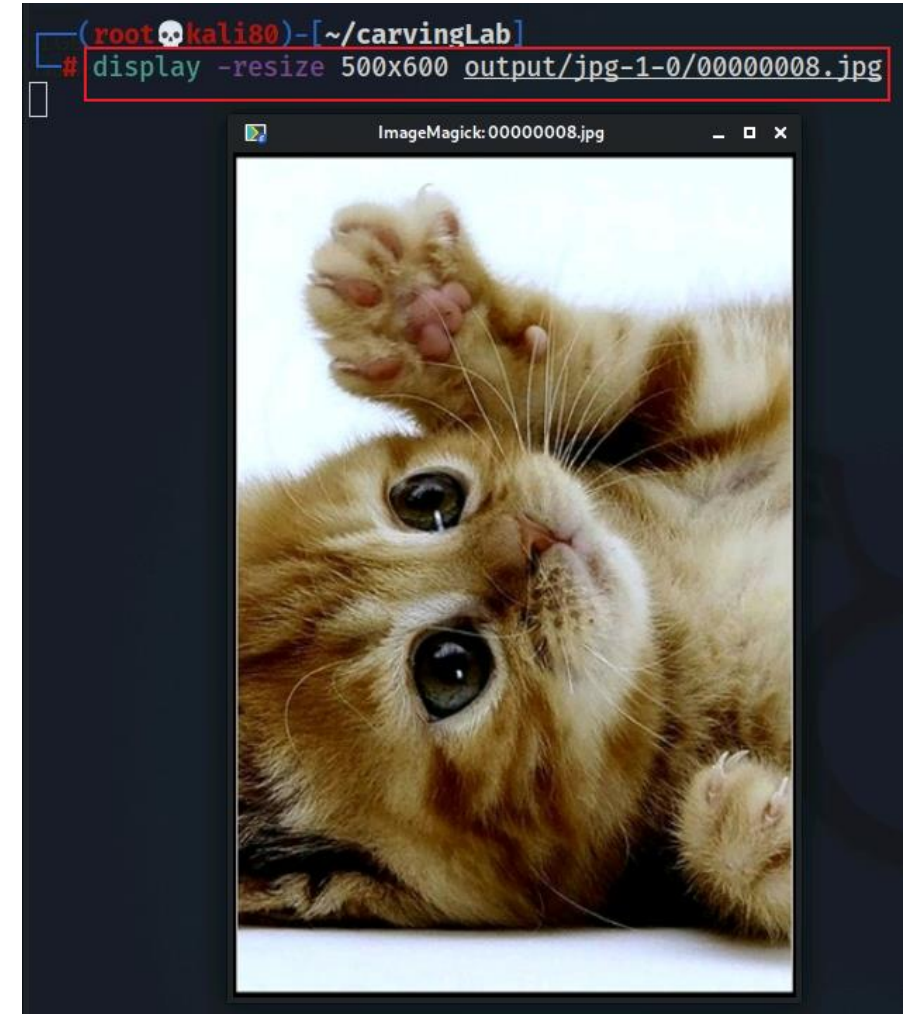
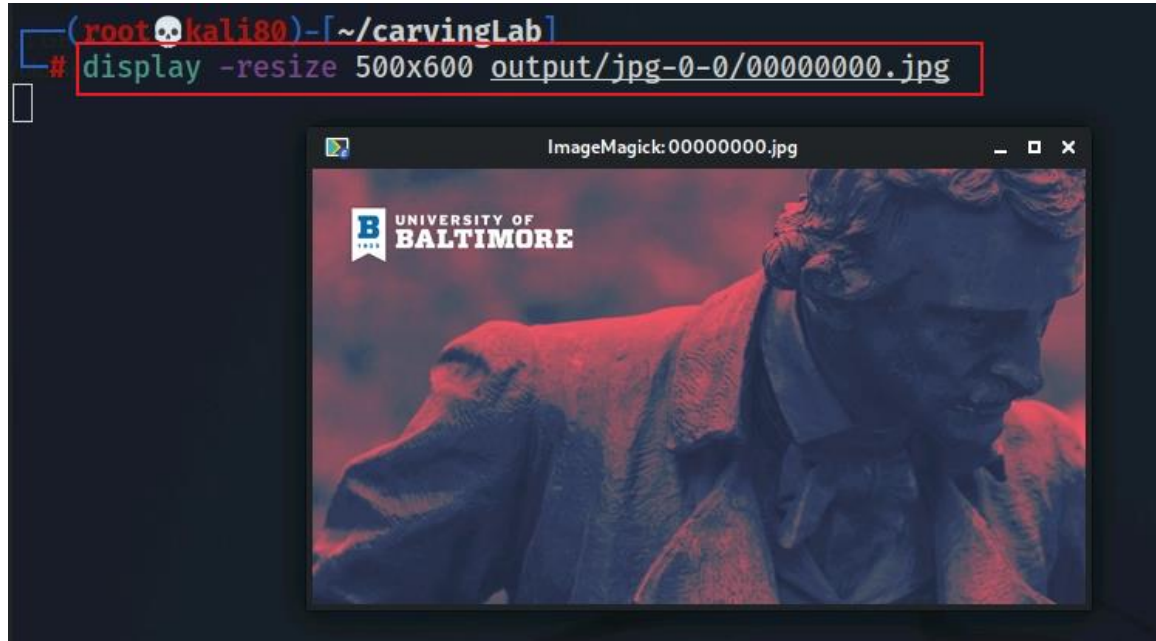
```
Opening target "H="
```

```
The following files were carved:
```

File	Start	Chop	Length	Extracted From
00000010.jpg	3796992	NO	3148500	usb_fat_carving.001
00000009.jpg	425822	NO	4875802	usb_fat_carving.001
00000008.jpg	335872	NO	4965752	usb_fat_carving.001
00000002.jpg	6938624	NO	6868	usb_fat_carving.001
00000001.jpg	5285888	NO	1659604	usb_fat_carving.001
00000000.jpg	3897344	NO	3048148	usb_fat_carving.001
00000004.jpg	15427584	NO	4223822	usb_fat_carving.001
00000003.jpg	12881920	NO	4256310	usb_fat_carving.001
00000006.jpg	19638272	NO	5229050	usb_fat_carving.001
00000005.jpg	17121280	NO	4248530	usb_fat_carving.001
00000007.jpg	21358592	NO	5183267	usb_fat_carving.001
00000016.jpg	36671488	NO	2889262	usb_fat_carving.001
00000015.jpg	36571136	NO	2989614	usb_fat_carving.001
00000014.jpg	36393610	NO	3167140	usb_fat_carving.001
00000013.jpg	36352448	NO	3208302	usb_fat_carving.001
00000012.jpg	35590996	NO	3969754	usb_fat_carving.001
00000011.jpg	35350242	NO	4210508	usb_fat_carving.001

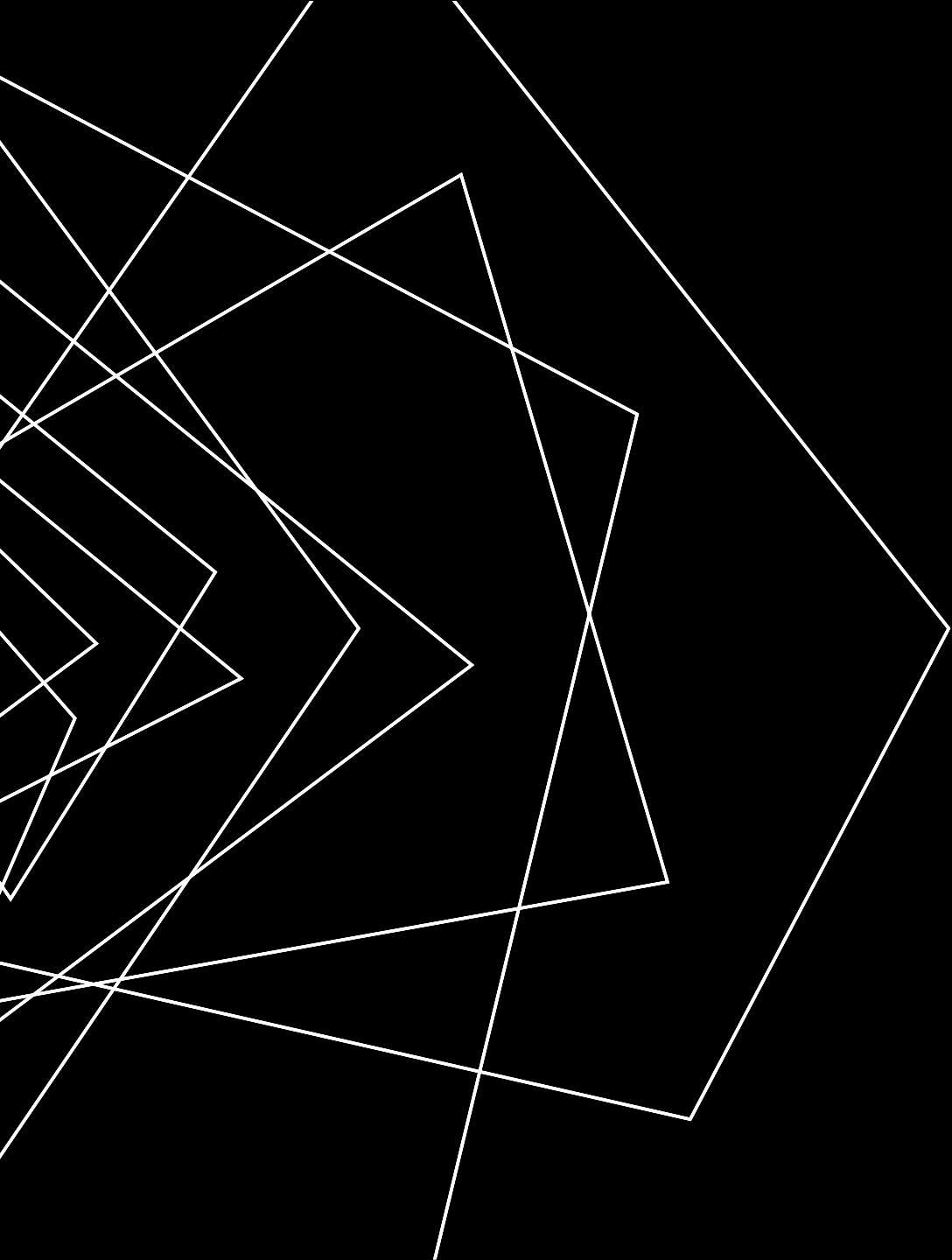
```
Completed at Fri Sep 24 11:20:43 2021
```

DISPLAY TWO CARVED JPG IMAGE



SUMMARY

- File header and tail signatures are used to identify file types
- The content of a file is enclosed in header and tail signatures
- Many tools can be used for carving file content
- Note the file names/metadata can't be retrieved



THANK YOU

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